City & Guilds
A City & Guilds Group Business

www.cityandguilds.com
February 2021 version 0.1

Functional Skills Level 1 English Writing Sample Paper 1

Worked Example – good pass

OFFICIAL MFS MODEL SOLUTION · BENCHMARK EXEMPLARY PASS

Comprehensive Exemplars (Full Tutor Analysis & Mark Scheme Grids)

- Assessment: Sample Paper 1 (Exemplar Benchmarks: Good · Borderline · Fail)
- Subject: City & Guilds Functional Skills English Level 1 Writing (4748)
- Complete accredited step-by-step models and tutor guidance
- Exam Board: City & Guilds (Ofqual Regulated Reform Standard)

Verified by Tutor Abdul (Senior Assessor) · MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk

MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

ONLINE LEARNING PLATFORM & ACCREDITED COURSES

Pearson Edexcel & Open Awards Accredited Suite · Entry 3, Level 1 & Level 2

Pass Your Functional Skills Exams With Confidence

100% Pass Guarantee | Dyslexia-Friendly Learning | 1-to-1 Expert Tutor Support

Master Functional Skills provides an adaptive, dyslexia-friendly online learning platform tailored for adult learners, apprentices, and NHS healthcare staff. Everything you need to revise, practice, and pass is at your fingertips.

1. Smart Diagnostic Initial Assessment

Calculate your exact working level and pinpoint knowledge gaps instantly

- **Exact Grade Calculation:** Adaptive assessments calculate your exact level across all topics.
- **Personalised Study Pathway:** Skip what you know; focus 100% on the topics needed to pass.
- **Real-Time Exam Readiness:** Predictive tracker confirms when you are 100% ready to book.

2. Comprehensive Video Lessons & Worked Solutions

Bite-sized visual explainers covering every single Maths & English curriculum standard

- **Step-by-Step Video Lessons:** Master percentages, algebra, perimeter, ratio, and reverse fractions.
- **Multi-Ink Handwriting Models:** Visual 3-colour methods showing working, carries, and examiner tips.
- **Tutor Shortcuts & Golden Rules:** Proven non-calculator mental arithmetic hacks and BIDMAS tricks.

3. Full Mock Exams & Real-Time Performance Analytics

Practice in exam conditions and watch your scores and confidence climb

- **Authentic Exam Papers:** Timed Section A & Section B papers formatted exactly like Pearson Edexcel.
- **Instant Topic Breakdown:** View percentage scores across Number, Measure/Shape, and Data.
- **Historical Score Tracking:** Monitor past attempts to ensure continuous improvement before exam day.

Ready to Master Your Functional Skills & Pass First Time?

Join thousands of healthcare staff, apprentices, and adult learners across the UK.

Instant 24/7 access on desktop, tablet, and mobile with no software to install.

START LEARNING TODAY AT

MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example – Good Pass

Question 1

Your task: write a report for people who are not technology experts explaining how technology (for example mobile phones, internet, social media, apps) benefits society.

In your report you may wish to include the following points:

- technology in personal life
- technology in business
- technology in the world as a whole
- what life could be like without modern technology.

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

Technology and it's benefits to society

This report will look at the benefits given to society by technology. In particular it will cover the following four areas:

- Technology in personal life
- Technology in business
- Technology in the world as a whole
- What life would be like without modern technology

Personal life is help by technology. Mobile phones are the most common form of technology available and most people own a phone, some people don't but they are few and far between. Phones allow people to do all sorts of things including comunicate with other's, texting, checking emails, surfing the internet and many other things.

Businesses could not survive without technology, they would be at a disadvantage to all other competitors, they have to use technology. Computers are transformed the way we do business. They allow buisnesses to do almost everything including advertising, running

websites, communicating with costumers, paying their staff and many other tasks.

The world has benefitted from technology because richer contries can help poorer contries fight diseases and provide things for the people such as water, electricity and safe places to live. On the other hand technology has also caused a lot of suffering in the world because it is technology that has allowed contries to make weapons and bombs used in wars.

It is hard to imagine life without modern technology. Technology is here forever and cannot be foergotten. Working without computers would be much slower because businesses would have to write letters and wait for replies or use the telephone more. Individuals would not be able to commubnicate instantly with other people and friends and relatives without going to see them. The cars on the road would be very simple and would not have things like satelight navigation. It would be a worser place for everyone.

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length	✓				
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing	✓				
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language		✓			
Overall band	Band 4				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	14

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example – Good Pass

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level** **4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time** **3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time** **2 marks**	**Limited accuracy** **1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence** **0 marks**	
Spelling		3				
Punctuation			2			
Grammar	4					
SPaG Total						9
SPaG mark + composition mark						23

Commentary

There is strong composition evidence. The candidate has answered the brief well, covering all the suggested points to a satisfactory degree of detail. The piece is approximately 300 words long. The format and structure are well handled, and the use of language is appropriate for the text type and audience. Complex sentences are used when appropriate and, punctuation errors notwithstanding, are generally well formed.

The candidate has demonstrated good use of commas to separate items in a list; however, there are several instances of a comma splice. There is also an incorrect use of an apostrophe and little evidence that commas can be used to separate clauses.

Grammar is consistently accurate, and spelling can be seen to be accurate most of the time.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example – Good Pass

Question 2

You buy a new computer from a shop in town, A-Z Technology Supplies. It stops working soon afterwards. When you contact the shop they are unhelpful, do not offer to repair or exchange it or give a refund.

Your task: write a letter of complaint to the shop manager. In your letter you should explain

- why you are writing
- what is wrong with the computer
- how the shop responded when you contacted them
- what action you would like the shop to take.

The person to write to is Mr Peter Jeffries, Managing Director, A-Z Technology Supplies, London Road, Manchester, M10 7JP.

Include all relevant details in your letter.

(27 marks)

15 Merchant Way
Romney End
Stanton
ST12 3YH

Managing Director
A-Z Technology Supplies
London Road
Manchester
M10 7JP

15/04/2020

Dear Mr Jeffries,

I am writing regarding a laptop computer I bought from your shop only 3 weeks ago. It is model number 056894. It is made by Assure Computers and cost me £499.99

Unfortunately it has stopped working and I am unable to fix it. This started about two weeks ago. The problems seem to be with the on

and off button. When I press the button nothing happens. I have to press it many times before it switches on. When it eventually works the battary charge is always very low so I have to have it plugged in all the time which is not very good for a laptop.

I took it back to your shop but the staff told me they couldn't help and were not responsable for fixing it or providing me with a new one. This really surprised me and I am sure that your shop does have a duty to help me. I thought you might like to know about how your staff are treeting customers.

I would be greatful if you could look into this for me and send me a reply to the above addres about what can be done. At the very least I would expect to be offerd a free repair and if that cannot be done I think you should give me a brand new computer.

I look forward to hearing from you very soon.

Yours sincerely,

S Michaels

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length	✓				
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing	✓				
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language	✓				
Overall band	Band 4				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	15

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example – Good Pass

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level** **4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time** **3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time** **2 marks**	**Limited accuracy** **1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence** **0 marks**	
Spelling		3				
Punctuation			2			
Grammar	4					
SPaG Total						9
SPaG mark + composition mark						24

Overall mark for question 1	23
Overall mark for question 2	24
FINAL MARK	47

Commentary

The composition is strong. Format and structure are appropriate to a formal letter, and paragraphing is well controlled. The language is appropriate at all times, allowing for a coherent, clear, appropriately detailed letter to be written.

Spelling is accurate most of the time and grammar is consistently accurate. The weakest of the three elements is punctuation. The candidate has strong evidence regarding sentence demarcation; however, the candidate is unable to accurately use commas to separate clauses. An apostrophe and commas after the salutation and valediction have been used correctly.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example – Borderline

Question 1

Your task: write a report for people who are not technology experts explaining how technology (for example mobile phones, internet, social media, apps) benefits society.

In your report you may wish to include the following points:

- technology in personal life
- technology in business
- technology in the world as a whole
- what life could be like without modern technology.

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

Technology benifits society in many ways, it helps people out from everywhere in the world. For instance mobile phones mean people can talk any where in the world or they can use apps like Facetime so you can see the person you are talking to. However they is some down sides to mobile phone because people are adictted and spends to much time looking at there phone. This can make accidents happen if they walking in the street and step on the road without looking.

Buisness also benifits from technology because they use it everyday. Computers are used in buisness all the time and they can not function without. All jobs use computer. Today they also use soical media to talk to costumers and sell their products. The goverment also uses technology to measure things and keep data on everybody. They also have a website where people can do things like pay bills and tax cars and look up things they need to look up, and they can report noisy neighbours if they are annoying.

Evrywhere in the world uses thechniolgy. We can fly to other countrys using technology in airplanes. Even boats use technology to get to one place to another and even cars. These days new cars have

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example – Borderline

sat navs that tell us directions where to go if we dont know where we are going.

The world would be a lot different if we did not have technology. No one would be able to talk to each other and we wouldn't know what is going on in the world. I think it is better we have technology.

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately		✓			
Writes text of appropriate detail and length	✓				
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing			✓		
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language			✓		
Overall band	Band 3				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	9

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling			2			
Punctuation			2			
Grammar			2			
SPaG Total						6
SPaG mark + composition mark						15

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example – Borderline

Commentary

Composition falls into band 3. The candidate has written a response of appropriate length and covers the relevant detail (irrespective of errors in sentence construction, grammar, etc). The information is communicated relatively clearly, with some coherence and accuracy. However, the candidate's use of appropriate language and their accurate construction of complex sentences are relatively weak. Similarly, format and structuring of the report are weak. There is no evidence that suggests the candidate knows the correct format of a report or how to internally structure it. The response would benefit from the use of a title and subheadings.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar are accurate only some of the time. There are frequent spelling errors, many grammar errors and very little evidence of accurate punctuation use beyond sentence demarcation.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example – Borderline

Question 2

You buy a new computer from a shop in town, A-Z Technology Supplies. It stops working soon afterwards. When you contact the shop they are unhelpful, do not offer to repair or exchange it or give a refund.

Your task: write a letter of complaint to the shop manager. In your letter you should explain

- why you are writing
- what is wrong with the computer
- how the shop responded when you contacted them
- what action you would like the shop to take.

The person to write to is Mr Peter Jeffries, Managing Director, A-Z Technology Supplies, London Road, Manchester, M10 7JP.

Include all relevant details in your letter.

(27 marks)

Mr Peter Jeffries
Managing Director
A-Z Technology Supplies
London Road
Manchester
M10 7JP

Dear Mr Jeffries

I am writting to you to complane about a computer I brought from your shop. I brought it on Saturday the 12th and today is the 21st and it has stoped working. The problem is that it has compleatly frozen until I switch if off at the plug. Then I can sytart it again but after five or ten minuets it is frozen again and I cannot switch it off except that I switch if of at the plug. I then switch it on again and the same thing happen.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example – Borderline

I took it back to your shop and explane the problem to the staff but they has said it is not there problem and they can not do anythink about it and I should take it to the mannerfacterer who will have to sort it out. When I said that is unfair and that it is the shops responsibliity your staff was just ruder and not very helpfull at all. I would of expected better from you. I think you should of replaced my computer with a new one because it was so new and I brought it from your shop. If you don't replace it you should offered to repare it for nothing because it was not me who broke it. It was obviusly broken when I brought it from you. I look forward to your reply and if I dont hear from you I will take this further and complain to the paper and on websites and soical media about you and you will loose alot of customers.

Yours faithfully

T Jones

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately		✓			
Writes text of appropriate detail and length	✓				
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing			✓		
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language		✓			
Overall band	Band 3				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	10

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example – Borderline

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling				1		
Punctuation				1		
Grammar		3				
SPaG Total						5
SPaG mark + composition mark						15

Overall mark for question 2	15
Overall mark for question 1	15
FINAL MARK	30

Commentary

Once again, the overall composition band is band 3. The candidate has not included any personal details on the letter so the company would not be able to respond. Although the content is clear, and covers most of the relevant detail, it is not functional without some way for the shop to respond to the letter.

This lack of detail is also penalised when format and structure are considered as the candidate has not demonstrated full knowledge regarding how to correctly lay out a formal letter. In addition to the missing sender's address, there is no date and the valediction is incorrect. Although the candidate has included one paragraph break, there are three instances where further paragraph breaks should have been included.

The language choice and register are generally justifiable, and the candidate has employed a range of sentence structures, including complex sentences.

Spelling is relatively weak, with errors in some regular words and irregular words. Even though some are typing errors, they are still regarded as spelling errors. Punctuation usage is limited to sentence demarcation. There is no evidence that the candidate can use commas to separate clauses or use apostrophes to denote omission or possession. Grammar errors are also present, although there is some evidence of good control of tenses and correct subject-verb and verb-tense agreement.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example - Poor Fail

Question 1

Your task: write a report for people who are not technology experts explaining how technology (for example mobile phones, internet, social media, apps) benefits society.

In your report you may wish to include the following points:

- technology in personal life
- technology in business
- technology in the world as a whole
- what life could be like without modern technology.

(27 marks)

Suggested word count 200 – 250 words.

Tecnology is poor for the world. It makes people stare at phone. It makes people not talk. It makes people lose friend's. Is benefit society by giving people phone's so they can talk to others and use apps to play games with others. Business use tecnology to make their work good and quick. They can email customers. Before they had to write letters. Now they can write email. It is quick. The world every where use technology. Even car's have technology. Computers use it and people can live with it. Life without it is worse for business. Life without it might be better for business and people. But they cannot do there job without it.

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately			✓		
Writes text of appropriate detail and length			✓		
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing				✓	
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language				✓	
Overall band	Band 2				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	7

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example - Poor Fail

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level** **4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time** **3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time** **2 marks**	**Limited accuracy** **1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence** **0 marks**	
Spelling			2			
Punctuation				1		
Grammar				1		
SPaG Total						4
SPaG mark + composition mark						11

Commentary

This response is very short. The question brief directs the candidate to write approximately 200-250 words, yet this response is only 113 words in length. This is taken into account when awarding marks, with the highest band available for composition elements being band 3, with the exception of format and structure. In this instance, the format and structure components are very weak, with no evidence available that indicates a report is being written, and no paragraph breaks within the text. Language is relatively poor and consists mainly of simple sentences.

There is a lack of clarity at the beginning and end of the response, where the reader is left confused as to whether or not the writer thinks technology is a benefit for people and businesses.

Punctuation is also limited. Apostrophes are incorrectly inserted, and there is no evidence that the candidate can use commas to separate clauses. Grammar and spelling errors are frequent, and the length of the response is also taken into account.

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example - Poor Fail

Question 2

You buy a new computer from a shop in town, A-Z Technology Supplies. It stops working soon afterwards. When you contact the shop they are unhelpful, do not offer to repair or exchange it or give a refund.

Your task: write a letter of complaint to the shop manager. In your letter you should explain

- why you are writing
- what is wrong with the computer
- how the shop responded when you contacted them
- what action you would like the shop to take.

The person to write to is Mr Peter Jeffries, Managing Director, A-Z Technology Supplies, London Road, Manchester, M10 7JP.

Include all relevant details in your letter.

(27 marks)

Dear Mr Jeffries

My computer is broken and I buy it from you shop. I have only it two week and now it is broken. Your staff say not your problem and he can not fix it. They say he can not give me a new one. It cost me over 500 pounds and I have a computer that not work. You need to fix it or give me new one. I have to work and now I cannot do it because my computer is broken and I want know what you doing about it. Please write to me back to tell me what you are doing about it.

Kind regards

Mr Riles

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example - Poor Fail

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and accurately			✓		
Writes text of appropriate detail and length				✓	
Uses appropriate format, structure and paragraphing				✓	
Writes with accurate complex sentences and uses appropriate language			✓		
Overall band	Band 2				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	6

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling			2			
Punctuation				1		
Grammar				1		
SPaG Total						4
SPaG mark + composition mark						10

Overall mark for question 2	11
Overall mark for question 1	10
FINAL MARK	21

Sample Paper 1 – Level 1 – Worked Example - Poor Fail

Commentary

There are significant details missing in the candidate's response, including their own contact details and the nature of the problem with the computer. The entire response is significantly shorter than the guidance given in the question brief, and this is taken into account when marking. The lack of a sender's address means the functionality of the response is greatly reduced. Format and structure are also affected by the omission of any addresses and a lack of paragraphing.

Spelling is generally accurate, but there are very few ambitious words, and punctuation is limited to simple sentence demarcation, although this is consistently correct. However, there are instances where commas are required to separate independent clauses, yet they have been omitted.

Grammar errors are frequent, with a confusion surrounding the use of pronouns when referring to the shop staff, omission of articles and other word types, incorrect word order at times and inconsistent and inaccurate control of tenses.

MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS STORE

OFFICIAL REVISION GUIDES, WORKBOOKS & FLASHCARDS

Written by accredited specialist tutors to match the exact 2026 Pearson Edexcel standards

Everything You Need To Revise, Practice & Pass Your English Level 1 Writing Exam



Core Writing Manual

English Level 1: Writing
Core Revision Guide

- All Edexcel formats (letters, reports)
- High-scoring Task 1 & Task 2 models
- Persuasive & organisational devices
- Dyslexia-friendly visual format

Spiral Bound Print & PDF

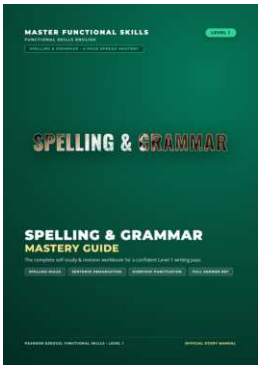


Guided Writing Drills

English Level 1: Writing
Companion Workbook

- 50+ realistic exam writing prompts
- Step-by-step planning templates
- Word-count & paragraphing builders
- Full Band 3 model answer keys

Spiral Bound Print & PDF



Full Grid B SPaG Marks

English Level 1: SPaG
Spelling & Grammar Mastery

- Master colons, semicolons & commas
- Complex sentences & tense control
- High-frequency exam spelling drills
- Secure 100% of Grid B SPaG marks

Spiral Bound Print & PDF



Pocket Flashcards A6

English Level 1
Pocket Revision Cards

- Compact A6 cards for quick study
- Format checklists for all text types
- Dual-sided rules & model examples
- Essential punctuation & DAFOREST tips

Boxed Card Deck & Print PDF

Order Official Study Guides & Revision Cards Online

Free Next-Day UK Tracked Shipping · Instant PDF Downloads Included

Trusted by NHS trusts, apprentices & adult learners nationwide.

VISIT THE ONLINE STORE

MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk